Sentences & Clauses (Set B)

Year 4 Pt 2 · **Homework Worksheet**

Worked Example

Worked Example: Classify this sentence as simple, compound or complex, and justify your answer: 'Because the storm knocked out the power, the whole street went dark.'

Answer: Complex — it has one subordinate clause ('Because the storm knocked out the power', which cannot stand alone) and one main clause ('the whole street went dark', which can).

Purple — Getting Started (15 questions)

1. Is this a simple sentence? 'The librarian stamped the book.' Explain your answer.
2. Identify the main clause in: 'The baby giggled happily.'
3. Which sentence below is a simple sentence? A) It snowed, and school closed. B) It snowed. C) When it snowed, school closed. D) It snowed because the temperature dropped. E) Although it was summer, it snowed.
4. Join these two simple sentences into one compound sentence using 'and': 'The oven beeped. Dad took out the pie.'
5. Underline the subordinate clause: 'Although it was dark, they kept walking.'
6. Underline the main clause: 'Although it was dark, they kept walking.'
7. Select ALL that apply. Which of these are coordinating conjunctions used to build compound sentences? A) but B) since C) or D) and E) unless
8. Write one simple sentence about a school trip.
9. Which sentence is a compound sentence? A) The lights dimmed. B) The lights dimmed because of the storm. C) The lights dimmed, and then the power failed. D) When the storm hit, the lights dimmed. E) The dimming lights flickered.
10. Join these two sentences with 'but' to make a compound sentence: 'She studied hard. She still found the test difficult.'
11. Identify the subject and the verb in this simple sentence: 'The crowd roared.'
12. In 'The bus was delayed, so we arrived late for assembly,' which word joins the two main clauses? A) was B) delayed C) so D) arrived E) late
13. Write a compound sentence of your own using the conjunction 'or'.
14. Explain why 'Jumping over puddles' is NOT a complete sentence.
15. Select ALL that apply. Which of these are complete simple sentences? A) The owl hooted. B) Behind the shed. C) Rain fell steadily. D) Although it was late. E) The gate creaked.

Green — Building Fluency (15 questions)

1. In 'When the whistle blew, the players stopped immediately,' identify the subordinate clause and the main clause.
2. Which sentence below is a complex sentence? A) The fog lifted, and the sun shone. B) The fog lifted. C) Although the fog lifted, it stayed cold. D) The fog lifted; the sun shone. E) The fog and the mist lifted.
3. Combine these two sentences into a complex sentence using 'although': 'He was nervous. He gave the speech.'

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4. Identify the subordinating conjunction in: 'Since the library closed early, we studied at home instead.'

5. Explain the difference between a main clause and a subordinate clause, using an example of your own.

6. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences are complex sentences? A) If the bus is late, we will walk. B) The bus was late, and we walked. C) We walked because the bus was late. D) The bus arrived on time today. E) Although the bus was late, we waited.

7. Rewrite 'The thunder rumbled. The lights flickered.' as one compound sentence using a semicolon instead of a conjunction.

8. Which word begins the subordinate clause in 'Unless we leave now, we will be late'? A) Unless B) we C) leave D) will E) be

9. Explain why 'Before the match began' is a subordinate clause and not a complete sentence on its own.

10. Write a complex sentence that starts with the subordinating conjunction 'Because'.

11. Identify the two main clauses in this compound sentence: 'The gardener planted the seeds, and the rain watered them.'

12. Which sentence correctly uses a comma after a fronted subordinate clause? A) Although tired she carried on. B) Although tired, she carried on. C) Although, tired she carried on. D) Although tired she, carried on. E) Although tired she carried, on.

13. Turn this simple sentence into a complex sentence by adding a subordinate clause beginning with 'while': 'Mum read a story.'

14. Explain why 'The bike that I borrowed broke down' is a complex sentence, identifying the main and subordinate clauses.

15. Select ALL that apply. Which of these words can begin a subordinate clause? A) since B) or C) unless D) yet E) when

Standard / Advanced (15 questions)

1. In 'The teacher, calm but firm, who had taught here for years, dismissed the class,' identify the main clause without being distracted by the interrupting detail.

2. In 'The storm passed quickly, yet the roads stayed flooded for days,' decide whether this sentence is simple, compound or complex, giving the one-word reason that proves it.

3. Which sentence contains TWO subordinate clauses? A) Because the road flooded, drivers turned back, although some pressed on. B) The road flooded, and drivers turned back. C) The road flooded. D) Drivers turned back because the road flooded. E) The road flooded, so drivers turned back.

4. Identify every clause (main or subordinate) in: 'Before the sun rose, the fishermen, who had waited all night, finally cast their nets.'

5. Select ALL that apply. Which of the following are genuinely complete sentences (not fragments)? A) Although the ferry was delayed. B) The ferry finally arrived. C) Waiting on the cold platform. D) Passengers boarded quickly. E) Because the fog was thick.

6. Write one complex sentence containing an embedded (mid-sentence) subordinate clause, marked off with commas, then label the main clause and the subordinate clause.

7. In 'Having packed her bags, Noor, who was running late, rushed to the station,' which part is the main clause? A) Having packed her bags B) who was running late C) Noor rushed to the station D) Noor, who was running late E) packed her bags

8. Explain why a sentence can be both compound AND complex at the same time. Give one example and label its parts.

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9. Identify the main clause and the subordinate clause in: 'The tower, which had been built in the 1800s, finally crumbled during the earthquake.'

10. Which sentence below is punctuated correctly as a compound sentence joined by a semicolon? A) The crowd cheered; the players bowed. B) The crowd cheered, the players bowed. C) The crowd cheered: the players bowed. D) The crowd cheered the players bowed. E) The crowd cheered — , the players bowed.

11. Rewrite 'The siren sounded. Workers left the building. Supervisors checked every floor.' as one sentence that is both compound and complex.

12. Identify two subordinate clauses and one main clause in: 'Unless the rain stops and the pitch dries, the final will be postponed.'

13. Explain why 'Even though she trained every single day' is a fragment, and turn it into a complete complex sentence.

14. Select ALL that apply. Which of these sentences correctly combine a main clause with a relative subordinate clause? A) The painting, which hung in the hallway, was priceless. B) The painting which hung in the hallway priceless was. C) I admired the painting, which is priceless, in the hallway. D) The painting is priceless which hung there. E) The painting that hung there is priceless.

15. Write a sentence with one main clause and two subordinate clauses (one at the start, one embedded in the middle), then label all three parts.

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